

MYLAPORE

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Washermenpet » Tondiarpet » Manali » M.R.C.Nagar » Teynampet » Mount Road » Broadway » Kondithope » Tiruvotiyur



THE LEGACY BEARERS

Two popular used-books shops that survive because the women running them want to preserve what has been bequeathed to them **P4&5**



A HEALTHY SHIFT

An increasing number of institutions in Chennai are opting for a mixed gender educational system **P6**

A resident of Luz Avenue challenges the redevelopment plan drawn up for the green space

'Concrete rebirth' of Nageswara Rao Park decried



LIFFY THOMAS

It pained Supraja Srinivasan no end to hear the shrill scream of the saw cutting through a tree and the final thud of a tree falling to the ground. Until last month, Supraja was being treated to these distressing sounds; her house overlooks the Nageswara Rao Park in Mylapore. Until last month, when many trees were being cut, she would scurry to the park and confront the contractor at the site about it, only to be told to talk to the executive engineer of Greater Chennai Corporation. Now, the sound of concrete being poured on the ground is keeping this Luz Avenue resident on the edge.

"The extent of concrete being laid on the park is alarming, you must come and see it. Does it make sense to put so much concrete in a park?" she wants residents to question the nature of work being carried out at the park.

She believes the redevelopment work at Nageswara Rao park is doing it more bad than good.

For her part, Supraja has been writing to various authorities including the Mylapore MLA and the Chief Minister seeking that a fresh look be taken at the plan.

On the GCC's grievance portal, she says, her complaint was either removed or cancelled without a reason.

As someone who has grown up around the park and enjoyed its various benefits, Supraja has every reason to question the nature of work that was commissioned during the previous regime.

The ongoing work which includes construction of a play area, a fountain, a gazebo and food kiosks will interfere with the park's environmental balance.

"One tree fell because they dug up a trench and the tree could not hold its weight. I requested that they transplant the tree but I do not think that is hap-

pening," Supraja says she also wrote to NGO Nizhal.

Luz Avenue, she says, rarely gets flooded in the event of heavy rains or floods thanks to the park.

"The park acts like a sink absorbing all the water during heavy rains. With so much concreting, that looks unlikely," she says.

Although Supraja is part of the WhatsApp group of Luz Avenue West Residents Association, she was not aware of the consultation meeting, if any, held before the proposal to start redevelopment of the park began.

"I have a packed schedule and there are only some things I can do. We need collective action to prevent the green space from diminishing further," says the working professional who maintains a khamba at home to compost waste and makes trips to Wasted 360's office in T Nagar to dispose of recyclable waste from friends and neighbours.

She invites more people to rally together to talk to the MLA. The work has also skipped deadline; and it is still not too late to act.

All that she wants from the authorities is that they assure residents that the area would face no water logging and promise them the park will get its lost greenery.



Recent images of how the park looks. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Meet Mylapore MLA on first and third Fridays

MLA for the Mylapore constituency P. Venkataramanan, who is also the Minister for Food and Civil Supplies, has started meeting resident groups and individuals.

A separate email id – mylaivenkattvk@gmail.com – has been created for people to share their grievances and get issues addressed.

The MLA's personal assistant Guna can be contacted at 63741 88528.

The MLA has set the first and third Friday of the month to meet the public at 6 p.m. at his office at the Corporation Building on C. P. Ramaswamy Road in Alwarpet.

Applications invited for best Tamil book award

Tamil Development Department of Government of Tamil Nadu has invited nominations for its annual award for best Tamil books. According to a press release, books published between January 1, 2025 and December 31, 2025 are applicable.

Works of poetry, novel, short story, drama, history, linguistics, grammar, fine arts (music, painting, dance, and sculpture), biography, autobiography, history, epigraphy, archaeology, religion, spirituality and psychology apply.

Also books on astronomy, mathematics, physics, chemistry, engineering, computer science, technology, environment science, veterinary science, anthropology, sociology, geography, environment, geology, law, political science, economics, commerce, and maritime and trade would apply.

Books translated into Tamil from other languages also apply.

Applications can be downloaded free of cost from the website of the department's website tamilvalarchithurai@tn.gov.in and submitted. The last date for receipt of completed applications is August 31. For details, call 044-28190412 / 28190413.



A call to *protect a park in Triplicane*

Residents of Chellapillayar Koil Street and Hussain Mulk Road in Triplicane want Greater Chennai Corporation to ensure a roadside temple does not “extend” into Balasubramaniam Park and the street space around it as well



An aerial view of the park and the temple; the park in disarray; and an older image of the park. PHOTOS: KANNAL ACHUTHAN

KANNAL ACHUTHAN

In an ironic twist, a small park that served as a breathing space amid the congested streets where Triplicane meets Royapettah, is gasping for breath.

Balasubramaniam Park is up against a twin assault: misuse of its premises for storage of construction equipment and material; and a roadside temple making “inroads”

into the green space meant for the public. Located at the junction of Chellapillayar Koil Street and Hussain Mulk Road, Balasubramaniam Park was an oasis of green in a drearily grey and congested area, marked by matchbox-sized houses tightly packed together.

As a resident of Chellapillayar Koil Street for two decades, M. Priya is at ground zero having a clear view of the abuse suffered by the

park. She notes access to the park, which once had children’s play equipment and benches for visitors, is now completely blocked.

‘Check the encroachment’

Until recently, the temple was only a temporary structure; but has been made a permanent structure now taking up public space. The park lying behind the temple is in disarray, its walls broken to bring in



construction equipment. Residents of streets around the park fear if Greater Chennai Corporation does not step in to take action, the park and the street space around it will be taken over by the encroachment.

“The temple has also temporarily blocked off access to Hussain Mulk Street,” says Priya, referring to temporary fire pit structures and a metal awning raised ahead of a

function at the temple on July 2.

A shopkeeper near the park says that the space has often been neglected by local authorities. “Earlier, we had trouble preventing people from using the park to keep cattle. Many a time, the space would be used by miscreants at night. But it is worrying that a private structure is gradually taking over the little public space available to residents.”

Club marks golden jubilee with new projects

Inner Wheel Club of Madras Midtown is empowering women to start their own enterprise

As part of International Yoga Day, Inner Wheel Club of Madras Midtown conducted a yoga session at Thousand Lights High School. The session was conducted by Viji Subramani and Uma Prasad.

Viji Subramani, a member of the

club, has been training the students for years by conducting bi-monthly classes. Children look forward to the sessions, and the training has brought about positive change in them, said a press release.

On the occasion, books, pens, and t-shirts were provided to the students

by Usha Bothra, president, and Brinda Reddy, member of the club.

This year marks the golden jubilee year of the club. As part of the celebrations, the club has started several sustainable projects. Under ‘Nari Shakthi, the Club is providing equipment for women to start their own business, diaper-making machines at Anandham, and distribution of physiotherapy and dialysis machines to organisations, added the release.



The legacy bearers

As India observes National Reading Month from June 19 to July 18, a peek into two popular used-books shops in Chennai that survive because the women running them want to preserve what has been bequeathed to them, despite daunting odds

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

R.K. Alwar did not want his books to be interred with his bones; and that was his final wish, not expressed on his deathbed but when he realised he was doddering towards it. Alwar's daughters Ammu and Julie have honoured that wish against daunting odds, ensuring the iconic Alwar Book Shop stays rooted to the spot where it has always stood at Luz Church Road in Mylapore. Alwar passed on in 2018 and since then his daughters have witnessed a parade of reasons to go back on their promise. If they had, nobody could have faulted them for it. The pandemic tested their resolve and the ongoing Metro Rail work has done the same thing. But these events had only ended up playing the devil's advocate, revealing to the world that this resolve comes with a cladding of steel.

Around Luz Corner and on this section of Luz Church Road, multiple retail businesses have trotted away in disappointment, but the duo has held on bound by that promise. Metro Rail construction has made Alwar Book Shop difficult to access, barricades and route diversions have discouraged many regulars from visiting it, and the once bustling pavement book shop is marked by a con-



(Above) Alwar's four daughters (from left) Eliza, Ammu, Julie and Lucy at Alwar Book Shop; and Alwar with his family.

spicuous lull. And changing reading habits induced by digital technology is queering the pitch further. But get this right, the daughters bear Alwar's legacy (which is their mother Ma-

ry's too; she also passed on in 2018) not as a burden, but as believers in it. There are believers from outside the family too. For them, Alwar's affable nature makes it compelling to believe

in his legacy and dream, which began in 1939. Ammu points out there are still a good number of customers best described as "loyal patrons"; they continue visiting the book shop because of their affection for Alwar.

The sisters take turns to look after the book shop both living just a stone's throw away from it for easy accessibility and for the unstated reason of refreshing memories. Family time has been around this shop. After marriage, Mary joined Alwar in managing the shop. Ammu recalls her maternal grandmother worked as a nanny at Good Shepherd Convent and, as a child her mother often accompanied her to the school, gradually acquiring English language with its myriad nuances. Though neither of their parents had extensive formal education, their love for literature was immense. "Our mother spoke English beautifully, and both our parents knew books and authors better than most people I have met," Ammu recalls in a tone betraying boundless admiration.

For their father, the bookstore was never merely a business; it provided him with meaning for existence; it was a dream he gave his youth away for. Ammu remembers how her father never spent a single night away from the shop and would brave torrential downpours to ensure not even a corner of a shop got drenched. She laughs while recalling, "He loved books so much that he would absent-mindedly call almost everything a book, even if it was a piece of cloth."

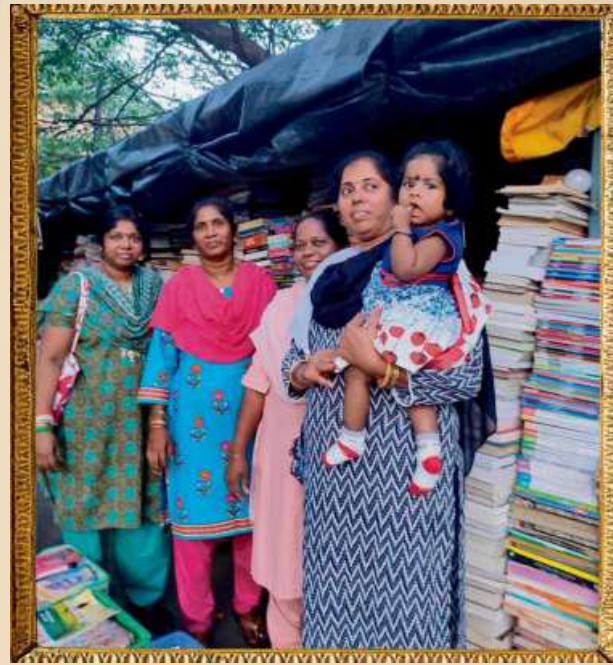
Perhaps the irony is the greatest story at the Alwar Book Shop is not inside any of those

thousands of books lining its shelves, and it is unwritten. This story is lived out every day by two daughters: returning to the same spot, made hallow by his father for those who worship learning and knowledge.

Ammu believes their father has never truly left the bookstore he established at this spot when he was around 16 years old.

Her voice choking and tears in her eyes, Ammu adds, "My dad is still here. We know he is. That is why we will never give up on this shop, even on our hardest days."

Alwar Book Shop, open from 10 a.m. to 7:30 p.m., offering fiction, non-fiction and academic books can be contacted at 9884773591



Scrap dealers probably do not warm up to old books with the same intensity as before; but surprises do crop up

The neighbourhood Kabadiwala as the bookseller

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

Before the digital revolution, "waste paper mart" was a handy hanger for synecdoche the literary device. Old newspapers and books were always the unlikely bully in a scrap shop, elbowing even heavy metal scrap to the sidelines. In a bloodless synecdochic takeover, these fragile items proudly represented the whole of scrap materials. And the neighbourhood Kabadiwala invariably appended "waste paper mart" to their shop's name. Rajalakshmi Waste Paper Mart on East Coast Road (ECR) in Pallavakkam established 26 years ago mirrors this practice.

Its owner T. Ponraja is winding up operations at Pallavakkam, the shutters to be downed for the final time sometime next week, when he would be launching into his second innings at a new address in Injambakkam on ECR, carrying over lessons and scrap items, not all of them, certainly not the used books and stacks of old newspapers. He notes he is going to the next level, and reveals there is no room for old newspapers and books up there. "I will focus on wooden and metal scrap."

Even at Pallavakkam, the old newspapers and books were not raking in the shekels; a whole truckload of other scraps did that for Ponraja. But he would



T. Ponraja has lost faith in sale of old books as a revenue stream; and (below) Abdur Rasheed believes a demand for them continues to exist.



still display old books he received, on a metal rack right next to where he would be seated. He would not sell those books by a standard weight math, but by deliberate pricing of each individual book, turning over to see the price on the cover. He wanted book lovers to purchase from him. Over the years as smartphone models became thinner, the stacks of books coming in became correspondingly lighter. Good used

book titles were slow in making it to the shelf and slower still leaving it. He has spread out the last stack of books on the shelf. And these books might be waiting for readers that will probably never arrive. No problem with the quality of the collection; only that their time under the sun is up. "Even if I sell a book worth ₹499 for ₹100, there are no buyers," says Ponraja, believing the downward slide began during the pandemic, and is speeding as dependence on technology for information deepens by the minute. "There was a time when he would have a steady stream of customers looking for old books. Their enthusiasm motivated me to collect more books. Now, I have lost my motivation." This is a recurrent theme across neighbourhood scrap shops, many of them not drawn anymore to keeping old books for sale. And that contrasts sharply with how in the past neighbourhood Kabadiwa-

las headlined the chapter on old books in the circular economy. They would welcome old books jettisoned out of households. Sellers of old books would buy from them on the cheap, usually by weight; sometimes residents would be buyers, in which case, the price would be higher but still strikingly affordable. These books would find a cosy shelf in a new home and then again be offloaded onto a tricycle to be carted to a Kabadiwala shop.

While a majority of Kabadiwalas believe the death knell for the used books trade is progressively getting louder, do not be surprised to meet some who continue to believe in it. Abdur Rasheed runs a scrap shop at East Abhiramapuram First Street in Mylapore where a notable display is a wall-mounted metal shelf which is always populated by used books that are sold by weight, a fixed ₹80 per kg. Books might contribute to a negligible part of his income, but he still buys them as scrap, displays them prominently for sale. Explains Abdur: "There is still demand for books; there are still customers coming for books, because of which I go and fetch books. It is an amalgamation of fresh and old books, often both in good condition."

In this National Reading Month, such stories are a sliver of hope for lovers of printed books.

The bookmark shifted from a page of grief to one of growth

On Mount Road, Siva Book House tells a similar tale of loss, memory and resilience. Founded and nurtured by brothers Siva and Sundaramurthy in 1977, the bookstore located in a shopping complex on Blackers Road off Mount Road is now run by Sundaramurthy's wife, Malliga with the assistance of their son Maheshwaran. For nearly six years, the mother-son duo has kept the shelves occupied, refusing to let the bookstore become a forgotten chapter. A homemaker for most of her life, Malliga never once imagined she would one day run the very store she used to visit only to bring lunch for her husband, whom she fondly calls "my sir". It was Maheshwaran, their younger son who insisted the shop should not end with his father's passing and patiently taught her the

nuances of bookselling. She now travels across Chennai using various modes of public transport to collect books as per the trends; a routine once unknown to her now defines her life.

The store, open from 10:30 a.m. to 8:00 p.m., has a range that extends from magazines and fiction to non-fiction and academic books. Siva Book House was a prominent presence on the pavement on Mount Road just a dozen footsteps away from the Anna Salai Post Office. Overtaken by various changes that unfolded on that section, including the razing of a shopping complex, Siva Book House moved "indoors" into this shopping complex on Blackers Road. With reduced visibility, the bookstore thrives largely on the patronage of old customers.

"If someone urgently needs a book,

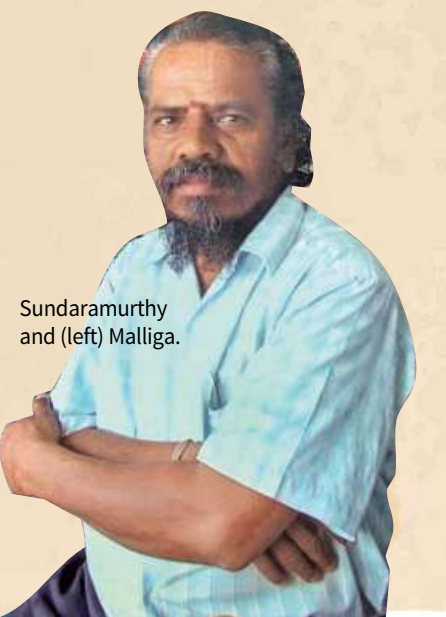
I will come as early as nine in the morning," Malliga smiles.

She fondly remembers how her husband handpicked every collection and occasionally took a young Maheshwaran along, unknowingly nurturing his love for books. Books entered Malliga's world through her husband's voice rather than the printed page. "My sir would narrate stories to me because I was not comfortable with reading any language," she recalls. "I may not have read them all, but I still remember every story he told." Though sales has declined with the rise of digital reading, Malliga believes technology can never replace the joy of walking into a bookstore, breathing in the scent of paper, and finding solace among the shelves. Their regular customers include teachers, government employees and media professionals.

Long after all the books on its shelves have been read, Siva Book House will have a story to be read, outside those book covers: the story of a

woman who stepped outside the confines of her home, picked up her husband's unfinished chapter and found the courage to keep writing it.

Siva Book House can be contacted at 9952934175.



Sundaramurthy and (left) Malliga.



READERS WRITE

No bus shelter at Sringeri Mutt Road



MTC route number 49 K starts from Mandaveli; and there is no bus shelter near Sringeri Mutt Road, Buckingham Canal. Commuters have to wait in the open and some can be seen sitting on the parapet. MTC must provide a temporary bus shelter here.

Text and Photo: Baskar Seshadri

Pedestrians in peril at Foreshore Estate

S. RAMANI

The Greater Chennai Traffic Police has to paint zebra crossing lines on Santhome High Road in Foreshore Estate.

The lines have been marked on Dr. D. G. S. Dhinakaran Salai. By doing so, pedestrians can cross when motorists from South Canal Bank Road enter Dhinakaran Salai.

A pedestrian signal is facilitated at the junction. But when the signal is activated, motorists from Sinthanai Sirpi Singaravelar Street are given the green light to enter Santhome High Road and South Canal Bank Road. In addition, motorists



from South Canal Bank Road make a free left turn onto Santhome High Road, putting pedestrians at risk.

Separate signals should be provided for motorists and for those from the Foreshore Estate region towards MRC Nagar.

LIFFY THOMAS

Two established colleges in Chennai are gearing up to welcome girls into their classrooms from this academic year, shedding the “male tag” attached to them over the decades.

Both the 184-year-old Pachaiyappa's College in Poonamallee High Road and 60-year-old C. Kandaswami Naidu College for Men in Anna Nagar (both run by the Pachaiyappas Trust Board) started taking baby steps towards transition into a co-educational system at the post-graduate level and for evening college respectively. This will be the first academic year when undergraduate courses would see a mixed classroom.

“We hope to fill at least 30 percent of undergraduate courses enrolling women this academic year. This percentage will be increased to 50 percent in the coming years,” says V. M. Muthuramalinga Andavar, principal of C. Kandaswami Naidu College.

Switching to a co-educational system is not a new trend, both at the school and college level, if one were to see how iconic institutions across cities have been taking this route.

In 2024, Government Arts College in Nandanam, one of the oldest men's college in the city, opened its gates for girls. Likewise, some years ago, MCC Higher Secondary School in Chetpet switched from a boys-only school to enrolling girls as well.



A healthy shift

An increasing number of institutions in Chennai are opting for a mixed gender educational system

Annai Velankanni's College of Arts and Science in Saidapet has also opened its doors for both boys and girls from this academic year, both at under graduation and post graduation.

In fact the college has transitioned from a women's only college to a co-educational institute to again switch to only accepting

women and now it is a mixed gender institute.

“In 2000, the college started as women's institute and after two years switched to co-education continued with the system for five years. Today, many parents and students are increasingly preferring a co-ed institute and one with a Deemed University

status,” says V. Radhika, principal, Annai Velankanni's College, adding that the management offers free education to deserving students.

Certain legacy institutions that are expanding their scope of education are also going the mixed way.

For example, Good Shepherd

flagged off its centenary year celebrations a couple of years ago by announcing launch of Good Shepherd Centenary School, a co-educational institution attached to the ICSE Board located on the same campus in College Road.

Why are some institutions moving towards co-education? Declining enrolment in single-gender institutions and growing parental preference for inclusive learning environments are key factors driving the shift.

Former headmaster and correspondent of MCC Higher Secondary School, G. J. Manohar, during whose time the co-educational stream was introduced, says the mixed classroom has certainly seen many positive outcomes, but there are challenges as well and it depends on how institutions handle gender equations.

“Today's workplace is all inclusive and to prepare them to face a heterogeneous group, it is better we bring them up in such an environment early on. I have noticed that children studying in a mixed group are better at appreciating gender values, and mutual respect is developed,” says Manohar, secretary, MCC Association.

Nirmala Krishnan, an educational consultant who has helped start many institutions, says research points out that those growing and learning in an inclusive environment are emotionally stronger and more confident of facing the world. She says gender sensitisation is best learnt and experienced in a mixed environment.

Rosary School welcomes new principal, school pupil leader

Rosary Matriculation Higher Secondary School commenced the Academic Year 2026-2027 with renewed enthusiasm and the leadership of a new Principal, Sr. Jasinth Quadras.

Sr. Jasinth has previously served with distinction as the Principal of Stella Maris College in Chennai, and later as the Principal of Maris Stella College in Vijayawada, says a press release.

Marking the start of the academic year, the school conducted the election of the School Pupil Leader (SPL) and Assistant School Pupil Leader (ASPL). The institution organized the elections through a

well-structured and transparent ballot process. Students actively exercised their franchise by casting votes using ballot papers and ballot boxes, thereby gaining meaningful, hands-on experience of democratic participation, the press note elaborates.

Three candidates contested for the position of SPL, while three others vied for the post of ASPL. The votes were counted on the same day, and the results were officially declared.

P.T Vaishali was elected as School Pupil Leader and Riya Kumaraguru as the Assistant School Pupil Leader. The newly elected leaders were ceremoniously crowned

by principal Sr. Jasinth. In her address, the principal encouraged the young leaders to carry out their responsibilities with integrity, dedication, and a genuine spirit of service.

The next significant event on the school calendar is the Investiture Ceremony, scheduled for July 2, 2026, during which the members of the Student Council will be formally invested with badges, symbolising the trust and responsibility entrusted to them. Parents of the elected leaders and council members will be present to witness this milestone in their children's lives, the release adds.

Bengalis honoured for their contribution

Members from various cultural associations were honoured at the Lok Bhavan on June 21 as part of the Foundation Day celebrations of Telangana and West Bengal states.

South Madras Cultural Association and the Bengal Association President Prodyot Bowmick and secretary Sandip Dey of South Madras Cultural Association felicitated the Governor.

Abhijit Bose, a member of South Madras Cultural Association and executive president

and COO at Tagros Chemicals Pvt Ltd, was conferred with an achievement award by the Governor for excellence in his field of work, said a release.

Kids choir gave a musical performance followed by a graceful dance performance.

From the Bengal Association, president Subhra Biswas and trustees Anjan Chakraborty and Parthasarathi Dutta Gupta were felicitated by Governor in recognition of their outstanding contributions and achievements in their respective fields.



DG Vaishnav College bags Dr. Sivanthi Adityan Rolling Trophy



Dwaraka Doss Goverdhan Doss Vaishnav College has received the 'Madras University Dr. Sivanthi Adityan Rolling Trophy' for producing the maximum number of university players (men) for three consecutive years (2023-24, 2024-25, and 2025-26).

The institution's secretary, treasurer, sports secretary, and principal congratulated and encouraged the Department of Physical Education's directors and students for their efforts and achievements.

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Deeksha wins three medals in swimming

Deeksha Sivakumar, representing Tamil Nadu, won a hat-trick of medals in the 79th Senior National championship held in Ahmedabad recently. Deeksha won gold in 4x100m mixed medley, silver in 4x100m freestyle relay and bronze in 4x200m freestyle relay events. A resident of Velachery, Deeksha is a student of Deeksha Sivakumar. She is currently studying in SRM Institute of Science and Technology.



Workshop on organic farming

Tamil Nadu Agricultural University Information & Training Centre is conducting a workshop on organic farming in cultivation of vegetable crops on July 2.

According to a press release, the programme will focus on chemical-free methods of soil nourishment and pests management. Also a culinary workshop on baking will be held on July 3. Various flavours of cakes such as coco, vanilla, and mango will be demonstrated.

Both the workshops will be held at the centre's premises at Agro Tech Green Park, First Floor, Thiru. Vi. Ka. Industrial Estate, Guindy. For details, call 044 - 29530048

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Building dreams

GRT Jewellers' scholarship programme to support 1,000 students this academic year

When Darshini first came across information about GRT Jewellers' scholarship programme on WhatsApp, she almost dismissed it as spam.

Recently, the B.Com student stood among hundreds of recipients at GRT Mahalakshmi Vidyalaya in Tiruttani, receiving support she believes will bring her a step closer to her academic goals. For students gathered on the sprawling

campus, the Endowment Scholarship ceremony was about more than financial assistance. For many, it was a reminder that educational aspirations need not be limited by financial circumstances.

As part of its Corporate Social Responsibility, GRT Jewellers distributed scholarships to students in the first phase of its 2026-27 scholarship programme. Nearly 1,000 students, including both existing and new beneficiaries, are expected to receive support this year.

G.R. Radhakrishnan, managing director of GRT Jewellers, said the initiative reflects the company's long-standing commitment to educational empowerment. He noted that the programme aims to recognise academic excellence while encouraging students to dream bigger and achieve greater heights despite financial challenges.



From the event.

The initiative was launched in 2021 and has steadily expanded in scale and reach. While scholarships remain at its core, the programme increasingly focuses on students from government schools,

those from economically disadvantaged families, and other underserved communities.

The initiative now includes mentorship and academic guidance to help students navigate educational

and career decisions. GRT is considering constructing a women's hostel to provide safe, affordable accommodation for women pursuing higher education away from home, added the release.

ZIMSON celebrates Father's Day with collectors



Zimson, a leading multi-brand watch retailer, recently hosted 'Legacy of Time - A Father's Day Watch Collectors Meet' at V R Mall.

The event was jointly conducted by Zimson, VR Mall, Chennai, and Chronoholic India, an independent watch-collectors' community, bringing together enthusiasts, collectors, and luxury lifestyle patrons for an evening dedicated to horology.

Participants explored timepieces from Rado, Longines, Tissot, and Zim-

son, while exchanging stories, discussing collecting journeys, and discovering the craftsmanship behind renowned Swiss watch brands.

One of the highlights of the evening was an interactive watch quiz hosted by Karan Madan, founder of Chronoholic India, where participants were tested on their knowledge of watch-making history, iconic timepieces, and horological innovations.

Karan Madan said, "Watch collecting is about preserving stories, herit-

age, and craftsmanship. Events like these provide enthusiasts with an opportunity to learn from one another, discover exceptional timepieces, and inspire the next generation of collectors."

An interactive and insightful session with the audience featured engaging conversations about watch-buying journeys, ownership experiences, antique mechanical clocks, and pocket watch collections, said the press release.

Roll the mat



At May Day Park in Chintadripet, many gathered to celebrate International Day of Yoga. PHOTO: RAGU R

Rally against drug abuse

Ethiraj College for Women observed International Day Against Drug Abuse and Illicit Trafficking with a massive human chain formation on Ethiraj Salai. Close to 3,000 students participated in the awareness initiative, which was organised by the Anti Drug Club in association with the Red Ribbon Club, Rotaract Club, NCC, Na-

tional Service Scheme, Youth Red Cross, Citizen Consumer Society and Ethishakthi. Holding placards carrying the message "Join Hands and Change Lives", the students raising slogans along Ethiraj Salai, which caught the public eye with their campaign against the menace of drug abuse and illicit trafficking, said a release.

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